STUDENT-FACING RESOURCE

Resume Self-Audit Rubric

An evidence-based check for machine-readable structure before submission

Name: _____ **Target role:** _____

Resume file/version: _____ **Review date:** _____

How to use: Export the resume to PDF, complete each check using the original file and its plain-text extraction, mark one score per row, and record the revision needed. Rescore after making changes.

Score key: 0 = Not satisfied 1 = Partially satisfied 2 = Clearly satisfied

No.	Criterion, check, and resume example	0	1	2	Notes / revision
1	**Text accessibility.** Select and copy the PDF text. Confirm that important content is not stored only as an image. **Resume example:** *"Jordan Lee | jordan.lee@email.com" can be highlighted and copied from the PDF.*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
2	**Reading order.** Paste the resume into a plain-text editor. Confirm that sections, bullet points, dates, and descriptions remain in a logical sequence. **Resume example:** *The pasted text follows "Education > Experience > Projects > Technical Skills" instead of mixing content from separate columns.*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
3	**Section recognition.** Use conventional, descriptive headings such as Education, Experience, Projects, and Technical Skills where appropriate. **Resume example:** *A heading reads "TECHNICAL SKILLS" directly above "Python, Java, SQL, Git."*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
4	**Essential information.** After text extraction, confirm that names, contact details, employers, degrees, dates, locations, and important qualifications remain visible. **Resume example:** *"Software Engineering Intern | Acme Labs | May-Aug 2026 | Newark, NJ" remains together after extraction.*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
5	**Technical-skill clarity.** Write programming languages, frameworks, databases, cloud services, and software tools explicitly, including clear multi-word names. **Resume example:** *Use "Amazon Web Services (AWS), PostgreSQL, Node.js, scikit-learn" rather than a vague label such as "cloud and data tools."*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
6	**Evidence and context.** Support important skills with truthful project, course, research, or work-experience descriptions instead of relying only on a keyword list. **Resume example:** *Project bullet: "Built a Flask REST API with PostgreSQL to manage more than 500 records."*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	

No.	Criterion, check, and resume example	0	1	2	Notes / revision
7	**Job relevance.** Use terminology from the target job description only when it accurately describes your qualifications. **Resume example:** *If the role requests Docker and you used it, write "Containerized a course project with Docker."*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
8	**Manual verification.** Compare automated feedback with the original resume. Review reported matched or missing terms yourself before revising. **Resume example:** *After checking a scanner result, add "Analyzed customer data with SQL and PostgreSQL" only if that work is accurate.*	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	

TOTAL: _____ / 16

REVISION WORKSHEET

Turn the score into an action plan

14-16 | Ready for final human review: Complete one last extraction check and proofread the actual PDF.

10-13 | Revise flagged areas: Fix every criterion scored 0 or 1, then repeat the self-audit.

0-9 | Rework before submission: Prioritize text accessibility, reading order, and essential information first.

> **Important:** This total is a revision-priority indicator only. It is not a validated ATS compatibility score and does not predict interviews or hiring outcomes.

Priority revision plan

Priority	Criterion to revise	Change I will make	Recheck
1			[ ]
2			[ ]
3			[ ]

Final verification

[ ] The exported PDF opens correctly and contains selectable text.

[ ] Plain-text extraction preserves a logical reading order.

[ ] Job-description terminology is accurate and supported by real experience.

[ ] A person reviewed the final PDF after all automated checks.

Privacy reminder: Before using external tools, consider what personal information is transmitted or stored and whether identifying details can be removed.